

HEALTH POLICY INDICATORS

- Health policy indicators are measurable variables—including mortality rates, morbidity, healthcare resource availability, and socio-economic factors—used to assess population health status, monitor policy effectiveness, and guide resource allocation.
- Key metrics include life expectancy, infant/maternal mortality, disease prevalence, and doctor-to-population ratios.

- **Key Health Indicators**

- **Mortality Indicators:** Crude death rate, life expectancy, infant mortality, maternal mortality, and child mortality rates.
- **Morbidity Indicators:** Incidence and prevalence rates of diseases, notification rates, and outpatient department (OPD) attendance rates.
- **Healthcare Delivery Indicators:** Measures of resources, such as doctors per thousand population, hospital beds per thousand, and population per health center.

- **Utilization Rates:** Proportion of the population using services (e.g., vaccination coverage, immunization rates, antenatal care coverage).
- **Nutritional Status Indicators:** Prevalence of low birth weight, BMI, and child growth stunting.
- **Social and Mental Health Indicators:** Rates of suicide, homicide, alcohol/drug abuse, and smoking.
- **Environmental Indicators:** Access to safe water and sanitation, and air quality index.
- **Socio-economic Indicators:** Literacy rates, income, and unemployment levels.

- **Purpose and Characteristics**

- These indicators are used to evaluate public health interventions, compare health statuses across regions, and identify specific health needs. Effective indicators must be valid, reliable, sensitive, specific, and feasible to measure.